



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident:	22/08/2022	Time of Incident:	6:30am – 11:30pm
Region / Directorate:	CNR – Goldfields Esperance Region	Main Roads or Contractor:	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type:	Procedure Breach	EQSafe Incident Number:	28058
Actual Consequence:	Insignificant	Potential Consequence:	Moderate

Incident Short Description:	Night Works was conducted without proper authorisation, potential fatigue risk
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Executive Summary:
On the Monday 22nd August, a crew commenced their day at 6:00am and began excavation of a trench across a south bound lane. At 11:00am the supervisor reported that the excavation process was slow due to rock. Following this report, a conversation between the works crew and Contractor Project Engineer discussed alternatives such as backfilling the trench if time becomes an issue and / or diverting traffic through the truck bay. The supervisor raised concerns due to cement stabilised sand having time to set prior to backfill. The workers discussed an alternative method and assessed that excavation would take an additional 1.5 hrs (1pm), pushing out the scheduled finish time to 6pm. The workers agreed to continue excavating the rock and reassess prior to confirming cement stabilised sand delivery. At 3pm the workers consulted the likelihood of working further into the evening and commenced discussion of risk assessment & controls, a review of the risk assessment, and discussion of a lighting tower over works, bunting, additional cones, fatigue management. The construction work changes that were made throughout the day impacted the working hours, and the crew did not finish until 11:30pm. Later in the scheduled works, 3rd party materials (cement stabilised sand) were planned for order, delivery and installation into the excavation. As the work progressed some materials were identified as non-conforming. Removal of the non-conforming material and subsequent safety of the site were not identified in the earlier risk reviews. Ultimately this unplanned situation impacted scheduled working hours, resulting in the crew not leaving site until 11:30pm. The Project Manager and Main Roads appointed representative were made aware within reasonable time of a potential delay in reopening the road at circa 7:00pm. The further delay attributable to non-conforming materials was not communicated until the start of following day.



Drain excavation and compaction

Contributing Factors:	
• Delays in works due to rock encountered during excavation and stabilized material batches were non-conforming • Did not seek approval from Main Roads to work beyond scheduled hours • Communication to relevant stakeholders • Works conducted after 6 pm were not in accordance with the Traffic Management Plan and Safety Management Plan	
Corrective Actions:	
• Communication Procedures to be updated to include requirements about carrying out work outside the notified working hours or on days other than the working days notified. • Ensure workers are aware of the Code of Practice working hours. Certain Working hours arrangements have been linked to safety and health risks, such as fatigue and impaired performance and increased exposure to some hazards.	
Distribution of Notice:	Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations